



IMMEDIATE ACTION REQUIRED - CORS Fix

Your CORS errors are happening because environment variables are not set on production!

⚡ QUICK FIX (5 Minutes)

Step 1: SSH into your backend server

```
ssh your-user@your-server-ip
```

Step 2: Check current environment variables

```
cd /var/www/GEMA-Project/backend
echo "FRONTEND_URL: $FRONTEND_URL"
echo "NODE_ENV: $NODE_ENV"
```

Expected: You'll likely see these are EMPTY or UNDEFINED

Step 3: Set environment variables

Choose ONE method:

Method A: Update .env file (if you have one)

```
nano .env

# Add these lines:
FRONTEND_URL=https://kidrove.com
ADDITIONAL_ALLOWED_ORIGINS=https://www.kidrove.com
NODE_ENV=production

# Save: Ctrl+X, Y, Enter
```

Method B: Restart PM2 with env vars (RECOMMENDED)

```
# Stop current process
pm2 stop gema-bac

# Start with environment variables
FRONTEND_URL=https://kidrove.com \
ADDITIONAL_ALLOWED_ORIGINS=https://www.kidrove.com \
NODE_ENV=production \
pm2 start dist/server.js --name gema-bac

# Save the configuration
pm2 save
```

Step 4: Pull latest code changes (includes trust proxy fix)

```
cd /var/www/GEMA-Project/backend

# Pull latest changes
git pull origin main

# Install dependencies (if any changed)
npm install

# Rebuild
npm run build

# Restart
pm2 restart gema-bac
```

Step 5: Verify it's working

```
# Check logs - you should see debug messages
pm2 logs gema-bac --lines 20

# Look for:
# 🔍 CORS Check - Origin: https://kidrove.com | Allowed: [ 'https://kidrove.com', ... ]
# [CORS] Origin allowed: https://kidrove.com
```

Step 6: Test from browser

Open <https://kidrove.com> and check browser console - no more CORS errors!

🔧 What Was Fixed in Code

1. Added Trust Proxy Setting

File: backend/src/server.ts (line 35)

```
app.set('trust proxy', 1); // Trust first proxy only
```

Why: Your server is behind nginx/load balancer. This fix:

- ☒ Fixes rate limiter warnings
- ☒ Allows correct client IP identification
- ☒ Enables proper HTTPS detection

2. Added CORS Debug Logging

File: backend/src/server.ts (line 47-50)

```
if (process.env.NODE_ENV === 'production') {
  console.log('🔍 CORS Check - Origin:', origin, '| Allowed:', allowedOrigins);
}
```

Why: Helps you see exactly what's being checked in CORS middleware

📺 Before vs After

BEFORE (Current - Broken)

```
✗ FRONTEND_URL: undefined
✗ Origin: https://kidrove.com
✗ Allowed origins: []
✗ Result: "Not allowed by CORS"
```

AFTER (Fixed)

```
☑ FRONTEND_URL: https://kidrove.com
☑ Origin: https://kidrove.com
☑ Allowed origins: ['https://kidrove.com', 'https://www.kidrove.com']
☑ Result: CORS allowed
```

🆘 If You're Stuck

Can't SSH into server?

Contact your hosting provider or server administrator.

Don't have .env file?

Use PM2 method (Method B above) - it sets env vars directly.

Still seeing errors after following steps?

Check `TROUBLESHOOT_CORS.md` for detailed debugging steps.

PM2 process name is different?

Find your process name:

```
pm2 list
```

Then use that name instead of `gema-bac`.

☑ Success Indicators

You'll know it's working when:

1. No more CORS errors in backend logs

```
pm2 logs gena-bac
# Should NOT see: "Error: Not allowed by CORS"
# SHOULD see: "Origin allowed: https://kidrove.com"
```

2. No more rate limiter warnings

```
pm2 logs gena-bac
# Should NOT see: "ValidationError: The 'X-Forwarded-For' header"
```

3. Images load on frontend

- Visit <https://kidrove.com>
- Check browser console (F12)
- No CORS errors
- Images display correctly

4. API responds with CORS headers

```
curl -I -H "Origin: https://kidrove.com" https://api.kidrove.com/api/health
# Should see:
# access-control-allow-origin: https://kidrove.com
```

🔗 Summary

Problem: Backend doesn't know which frontend domain to allow

Root Cause: `FRONTEND_URL` environment variable not set

Solution: Set `FRONTEND_URL=https://kidrove.com` in production environment

Time to Fix: ~5 minutes

Files Changed: `backend/src/server.ts` (trust proxy + debug logging)

Need more help? See `TROUBLESHOOT_CORS.md` for detailed debugging steps!